

DESCRIPTION

This ceramics throwing course intends to further both technical skills and to impart clear analytical practices for iterating on and refining work. The core technical skills center on throwing efficiency and ergonomics but include explorations of alternative throwing systems, larger throwing, throwing off the hump, and techniques off the wheel as well.

CALENDAR

Session 1

Centering, Opening / Drawing

9/28 7:30-9:30pm

- **Drawing:** Using the paper sheets passed out in class, draw a mug silhouette inside the 4x5 inch box. Cut out the better half of your silhouette and paste it onto a piece of cardboard. Then cut out the mug portion of your drawing to make a form tool.
- **Opening Short:** Demo. Center clay into a puck, dig down about 1 cm and open into short walls, dig down another 1 cm and open into short walls again, continue until you get to the wheel head. Focus on cleanly blending the opened clay into the existing walls.
- **Opening Tall:** Demo. Center clay into a flat topped cone. Slowly drill down into the center with your left thumb while lightly controlling the walls splaying out with your right hand. Notice how it is easier when you move more slowly and pay attention to clay stickiness.
- **Centering Practice:** We cover centering short and tall. For practice, center 1.5 to 3lbs, knock off center, recenter without adding water, repeat until failure. Focus on how the stickiness of the clay changes with less water and start over after 10-20 recenters.

Session 2

Pulling, Shaping / Timing

10/5 7:30-9:30pm

- **Pulling:** Demo of Knuckle Pull, Collar Pull, Compression Pull.
- **Shaping:** Demo the fundamentals of using ribs for shaping.
- **Timing Practice:** Prepare 10 balls of clay each weighing 1lb, start a five minute timer with the intention to throw the mug shape made in Session 1, when the time goes off wire off the piece even if it is not finished and cut it in half to check wall thickness. Rest for 1ish minute between pots but don't do any analysis until all 10 balls have been thrown. Notice how throwing is easier as you focus only on throwing techniques and not on what the outcome is.

Session 3

Trimming, Texture, and Handles

10/12 7:30-9:30pm

- **Trimming:** Demo using counter friction to trim quickly.
- **Texture:** Demo using various tools to add texture and shape to leatherhard work.
- **Handles:** Demo pulling handles and sculpting handles.

Session 4

Throwing Larger

10/19 7:30-9:30pm

- **Centering:** Demo centering 3 to 5lbs of clay using a medium speed and less strength using the top and bottom technique.
- **Opening:** Demo using the tall opening method. Drill down until the left hand is full of clay. If there is still more clay to go, use the left fist to punch down into the clay and compress the base. Lastly, use the flat outside of the left thumb and the right palm to lightly compress and even the walls.
- **Big Pulls:** Demo thick pulls with the flat thumb and palm of outside hand. Collar pulls to get initial height. Big knuckle pulls for initial height.
- **Practice Larger:** Untimed practice of the large throwing techniques.

Session 5

The Hump

10/26 7:30-9:30pm

- **Buttons:** Demo throwing small buttons off the hump to exercise wiring off with string.
- **Small Plates:** Demo throwing small plates off the hump to exercise a basic compression pull without shaping.
- **Small Bowls:** Demo throwing small bowls off the hump to exercise the compression pull with shaping.
- **Mugs:** Once some small plates and bowls have been thrown try making a mug that matches your form from day 1.
- **Teapots:** Demo of throwing all the necessary parts for a teapot off the hump.

Session 6

Glazing

11/2 7:30-9:30pm

- **Underglaze:** Demo using underglaze directly with sgraffito.
- **Dipping Glaze:** Demo dipping cups, bowls, and larger vases.
- **Resists:** Demo using resists over shino.

Session 7

Review

11/9 7:30-9:30pm

At this point we have covered many fundamental topics which will be reviewed. Students are encouraged to ask for clarification or deeper discussion of the topics that most interest them. We will also cover techniques for finding and developing new ideas before throwing, how to build a rubric for assessing your own work without relying on vibes, and a couple of starting points for further exploration.